



PROBATION OFFICER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Probation officers work with criminal offenders before, during, and after they are sentenced by the courts. In this job, you ensure that offenders carry out their sentences and help them return to the community, monitoring them carefully, and working toward their rehabilitation. You may work with courts, prison and police services, and social and community organizations on initiatives to prevent reoffending.



SALARY

Probation services officer ★★★★★

Probation officer ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Political factors determine the resources available to probation services • Intense scrutiny of the profession by media and government

CAREER PATHS

Probation officers work for a regional or national probation service, or for a private company that specializes in the rehabilitation of offenders. Routes into the career vary greatly country by country, but a relevant degree and vocational qualifications are expected. Once qualified, you can choose to move into managing the work of other officers, or specialize in one area of offender rehabilitation.

TRAINEE You can join a state or federal government training program once you have completed vocational qualifications. Experience of working with prisoners or providing support to victims of crime is helpful. Many permanent positions require you to be a trainee for one year first.

GRADUATE If you hold a degree in criminology, police studies, or criminal justice, you can combine working for a probation service with studying for a qualification in community justice, which will qualify you to work as a probation officer.



REHABILITATION OFFICER

Helps people addicted to drugs, alcohol, or other substances, or those with behavioral issues, to lead active, independent lives.



PROBATION OFFICER You supervise offenders on parole or assess the risks they may pose to the community, and write reports for the courts and prison authorities. You may specialize in areas including high-risk offenders, people with addiction problems, or hostel management.